

MATHAN KUMAR

Full Stack Engineer | Java · Spring Boot · React · JavaScript · Guidewire

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full Stack Software Engineer with 14+ years of experience building and scaling high-performance backend systems and user-facing web applications. Deep expertise in Java and Spring Boot for backend services, with hands-on frontend delivery using React.js and JavaScript (ES6+). Proven track record of solving complex, large-scale engineering challenges: re-architecting a latency-critical system to achieve a ~73% reduction in response time (8.2s → 2.2s) through parallel processing and distributed microservices design. Strong grasp of data structures, algorithms, and system design fundamentals, with a consistent focus on building efficient, scalable, reusable, and accessible software. Experienced in leading and mentoring engineers, driving technical decisions, and collaborating across cross-functional teams in fast-paced environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Java (8+), JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, Python, SQL, Gosu
Backend	Spring Boot, Spring MVC, Microservices, REST APIs, SOAP, Distributed Systems
Frontend	React.js, HTML5, CSS3, Jest, React Testing Library
Data & Storage	PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Redis (caching patterns)
Cloud & DevOps	Microsoft Azure, Azure API Management, Docker, CI/CD Pipelines, PM2
Practices	Data Structures & Algorithms, System Design, TDD, Code Review, Agile/Scrum
Tools	Git, Node.js, FastAPI, Vite, Nginx, Tailscale, Proxmox

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Hastings Direct | UK

Senior Software Engineer & Engineering Lead

May 2020 – Present

Senior full stack engineer and engineering lead at a UK digital insurance carrier, responsible for designing and delivering scalable backend services, full stack customer platforms, and high-throughput data integrations across distributed systems.

Full Stack Platform Development

- Architected and delivered a React.js self-service claims platform end-to-end, owning component design, state management, API integration, and test coverage using Jest and React Testing Library.
- Built scalable backend integrations using Azure API Management (APIM), enabling reliable data exchange between internal systems and external third-party services.
- Designed reusable, modular frontend components aligned to accessibility standards, improving usability across diverse customer segments.

Microservices Modernisation – Quote Hub (Backend Systems)

- Worked on the implementation of a monolithic quote processing system into parallelised Spring Boot microservices, reducing end-to-end latency by ~73% (8.2s → 2.2s).
- Implemented concurrent service orchestration using Java CompletableFuture, enabling parallel execution of independent downstream API calls.
- Designed robust integration patterns with external aggregator APIs including retry logic, timeout handling, and graceful degradation for resilience at scale.
- Built dedicated search and retrieve microservices with purpose-built datastores, applying appropriate data structure choices to optimise query performance.
- Mentored engineers on algorithmic problem-solving, clean code practices, and structuring backend logic for scalability, testability, and long-term maintainability.

Engineering Leadership

- Line manager for 3 engineers; recognised as 'Best Leader' (Q1 2025), fostering a culture of technical rigour, continuous learning, and high-quality delivery.
- Conducted design reviews, code reviews, and architecture discussions to uphold engineering standards across the team.

LV= | London, UK

Software Engineer – Integrations

Nov 2019 – May 2020

Contracted as a specialist integration engineer at one of the UK's largest insurers, delivering full stack data integration solutions across core insurance platforms.

- Designed and built API integrations (REST and SOAP) between core policy management systems and external aggregator platforms, handling complex data transformation and business rule enforcement.
- Implemented end-to-end integrations across billing and policy systems, writing well-structured, maintainable backend code in Java and Gosu.
- Produced technical documentation covering data flows, API contracts, and system interactions to support ongoing development and onboarding.

EY (Ernst & Young) | London, UK & India

Technical Lead – Software Engineering

Nov 2014 – Nov 2019

Led a team of 4–6 engineers delivering full-cycle software implementations for global insurance clients, with ownership of backend services, integrations, and technical delivery quality.

- Designed and built backend integrations for complex business workflows including FNOL processing, payment handling, and large-scale file-based data exchange.
- Applied data structures and algorithmic thinking to design efficient data transformation pipelines handling high-volume insurance transaction data.
- Acted as primary technical contact, translating business requirements into well-structured, scalable software components across the full stack.
- Drove code quality through regular reviews, pair programming, and hands-on mentoring — raising overall engineering standards across offshore delivery teams.
- Delivered solutions in Java across multiple client engagements, consistently meeting functional and non-functional requirements including performance and reliability.

IGATE | India

Senior Software Engineer

Jan 2014 – Nov 2014

- Developed enterprise web applications using Spring MVC, Hibernate, PL/SQL, and AWS S3 for cloud-based file storage and retrieval.
- Implemented backend business logic and RESTful APIs consumed by front-end web interfaces.

Tech Mahindra | India

Software Engineer

Jun 2011 – Dec 2013

- Built and maintained Java-based backend applications for telecom clients, developing core competencies in object-oriented design, data structures, and SDLC practices.

PERSONAL PROJECTS & ENGINEERING

- Trade Analytics Platform: Built a full stack app (FastAPI backend, React/Vite frontend, PostgreSQL) with hybrid REST/RPC API, real-time chart endpoints, and smart component architecture.
- MCP Server & AI App: Built a Model Context Protocol server using Node.js/Express with SSE streaming and OpenRouter LLM integration, deployed via PM2 and systemd.
- Homelab Infrastructure: Self-hosted Proxmox VE cluster on bare-metal server; containerised services (Docker/LXC) including databases, reverse proxies, and monitoring tools.
- Trading Journal Bot: Spring Boot Telegram bot with PostgreSQL persistence, deployed to Hetzner VPS with Docker Compose and systemd — demonstrating end-to-end production deployment.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Docker Foundations Professional Certificate
- Guidewire Certified Specialist – Integration
- Kotlin & Android Certifications

EDUCATION

B.Tech in Information Technology

Anna University